

THE 2026 RESTORATION MARKETING REALITY

WINNING WITH THE RIGHT MEDIA MIX

Rainbow Restoration National Conference 2026

HOW YOUR CUSTOMERS FIND YOU HAS CHANGED

HAS YOUR MARKETING KEPT UP?

YOUR MEDIA MIX IS YOUR SYSTEM

- It's every marketing channel you invest in — and how they connect
- Most operators have a list of channels. The best operators have a **system**.

CAPTURE

Demand that
already exists

CREATE

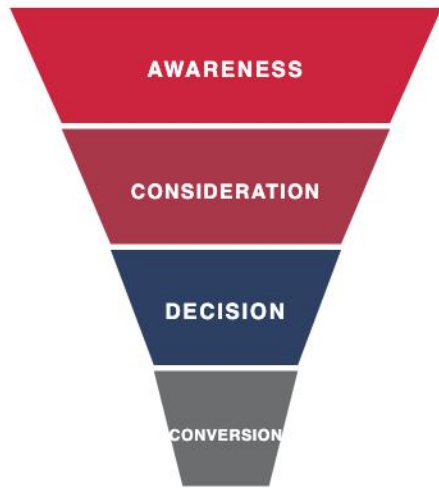
Demand before the
emergency happens

CONVERT

Attention into
booked jobs

Most restoration companies are good at one of these. The ones growing are covering all three.

THE MARKETING FUNNEL



- **AWARENESS**

Social media, sponsorships, YouTube, vehicle wraps

- **CONSIDERATION**

Retargeting, blog content, SEO, email nurture

- **DECISION**

LSA, Google Ads, SEO (high-intent), GBP

- **CONVERSION**

Website, reviews, speed to lead, follow-up

Restoration is emergency-driven. The consideration phase is far shorter than most industries. Trust has to be built BEFORE the emergency.

THE LANDSCAPE IS SHIFTING

29%

of homeowners already have a
company name in mind
when they search

+27.8%

Google Ads spend growth
across our restoration clients

+63.9%

LSA spend growth
across our restoration clients

- Businesses in LSA results get **25-30% more calls** than those relying on organic alone
- **31% of consumers now require 4.5+ stars** to consider a business — up from 17% last year

Your competitors are spending more every quarter. But the operators winning aren't just spending — they're building recognition before the emergency.

WHAT YOUR CUSTOMERS RESPOND TO

97%

of restoration operators say referrals
are their #1 source of new business

58%

of homeowners were influenced
by a blog post in the last 30 days

55,352

restoration establishments
competing for attention nationwide

- Homeowners are 12% more likely to check a company's blog to evaluate expertise
- 41% called or visited the advertiser after seeing an ad — **136% higher** than the general population
- Only 3.5% of restoration customers say they don't read online reviews — **nearly everyone checks**

Sources: AdMall/SalesFuel 2025; Cleanfax Restoration Benchmarking Survey 2024

AI IS CHANGING HOW CUSTOMERS FIND YOU

14.2%

AI Conversion Rate

2.8%

Google Conversion Rate

5x

AI Converts Higher

THE REALITY

- Google still handles 90% of search
- AI converts at **5x the rate**
- 41% of restoration customers use AI to research

THE GOOD NEWS

- Google and AI reward the **same thing**
- Authoritative content, strong reviews, managed GBP
- A brand worth citing — AI recommends what it "knows"

You don't need two strategies. Google and AI are two systems rewarding the same thing.

WHAT THIS MEANS FOR YOUR FUNNEL

- **The bottom of the funnel still matters most.** LSA and PPC are where leads come from. But costs are up 20.9% — the bottom alone isn't enough anymore.
- **The top of the funnel makes the bottom work harder.** Branded searches convert at 6x the rate of generic terms. Awareness doesn't replace demand capture — it supercharges it.
- **AI is the new front door.** 41% of your potential customers are using AI to research you. Your content, reviews, and GBP feed what AI recommends.

Keep investing in the bottom. But the operators pulling ahead are the ones adding layers above it.

WORKSHOP

BUILD YOUR MARKETING FUNNEL

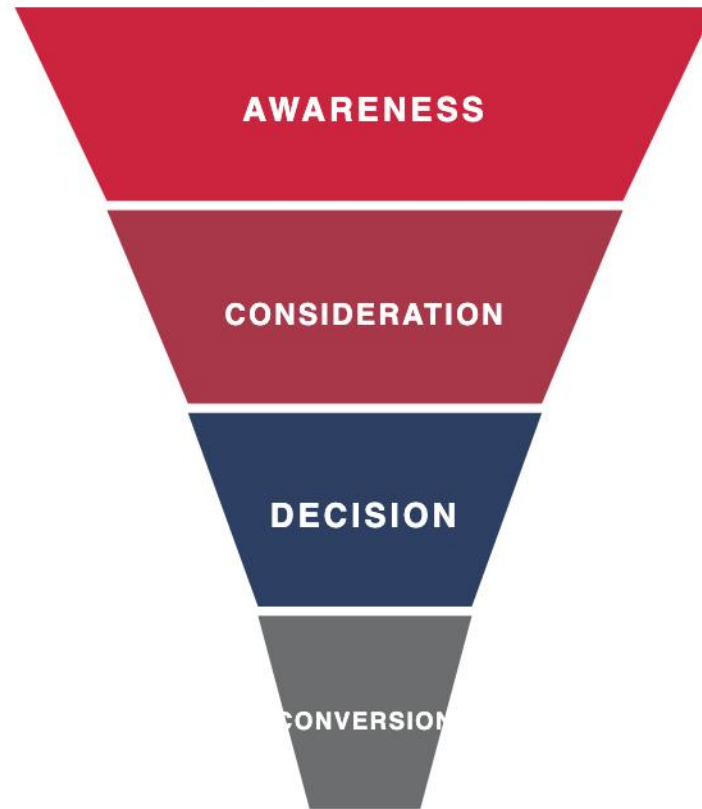


Scan to open the
Workshop Worksheet

or use the printed copy at your seat

WHERE DOES YOUR MARKETING FIT?

Map each activity to one of these four stages.



STEP 1: MAP WHAT YOU'RE DOING

- Write down every marketing activity you're currently doing
- For each one, answer: **WHY** are you doing this?
- Then answer: **WHERE** does it fit in the funnel?
- Don't overthink it. Just get it all on paper.

STEP 2: FIND THE GAPS

- Which funnel stages have the most activity? Which have none?
- Heavy on Decision (LSA, PPC) but light on everything else?
- No Awareness activity at all?
- Nothing in Conversion beyond "we answer the phone"?
- **Circle the biggest gap — that's your #1 priority**

STEP 3: PICK YOUR NEXT MOVE

- Based on your gaps, choose **1-3 things** you want to add to your marketing
- For each one, write down: **What is it?**
- Where does it fit in the funnel?
- Why this one?
- Don't worry about the "how" yet — **that's what we're here for**



BUILD THE SYSTEM. COVER THE FUNNEL. WIN THE MARKET.

Authoritative content. Strong reviews. A brand worth citing.



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